EL SALVADOR (3 September)

Normal weather conditions have resumed, benefiting planting of the 1998/99 first season cereal and bean crops. Harvesting has just started and a significant recovery in maize production, the main cereal, is expected from last year's El Niño affected crop. Maize imports in 1998/99 marketing year are forecast to decline considerably from the relatively high volume of 330 000 tonnes imported in 1997/98 (August/July).


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